INDIA TODAY ARCHIVES



PRASHANT PANJIAR



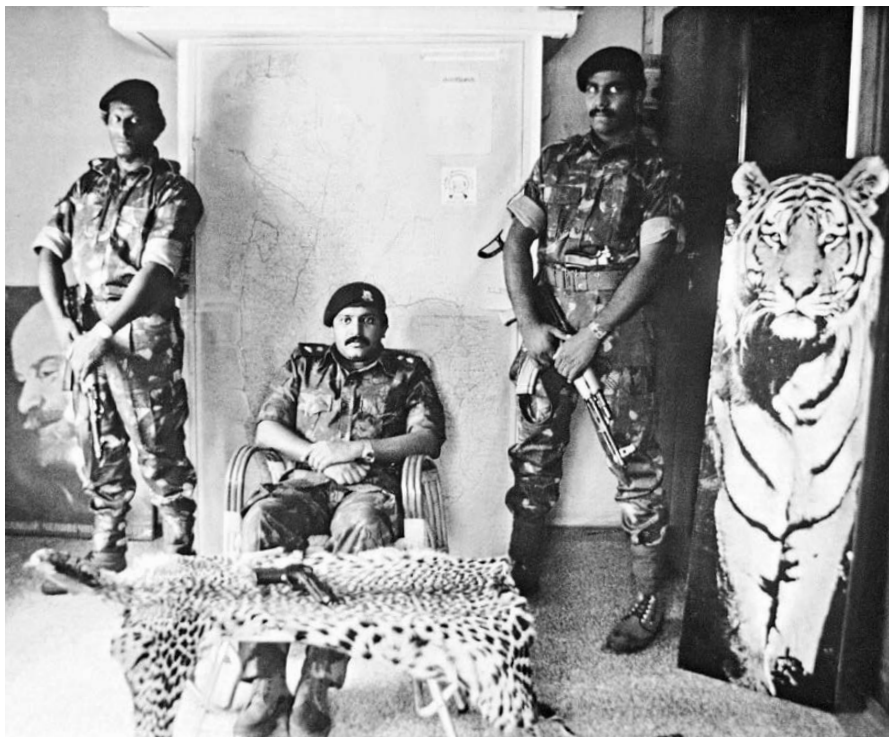


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**Punjab terrorism, 1985-95:** The Sikh massacre of 1984 casting a long shadow behind it, the decade was bookended by two assassinations—Akali leader Harcharan Longowal (1985) and ex-CM Beant Singh (1995)—with nearly 200 targeted Hindu killings on buses/trains, and Operation Black Thunder, in between.

**IPKF war, 1987-90:** India was sucked willy-nilly into this blunder, a peacekeeping operation that turned into a prolonged, morally grey combat in the Lankan jungles that left all sides bleeding. There would be hell to pay, beyond the 1,100-plus body bags.

**Kashmir insurgency, 1987:** The Kashmir 'problem' was



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**TURN FOR THE WORSE**
(Clockwise from top) Mourners carry Akali Dal president Harchand Longowal's body after Sikh militants opposed to the Rajiv-Longowal Accord assassinated him, 1985; Velupillai Prabhakaran, chief of the Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam (LTTE), in the early 1980s; Anti-Sati rally in Jaipur after Roop Kanwar's (inset) immolation, 1987